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MEMORANDUM

TO: The Secretary

THROUGH: S/S

SUBJECT: Procedure to Adopt the terms Taiwan and Penghu for Formosa and Pescadores

Discussion

Under Public Law 242, 80th Congress, the Board on Geographic Names, subject to the approval of the Secretary of the Interior, is granted authority to decide standard geographic names and their orthography and establish procedures to that end. The Board, in 1933 and again in 1953, designated Taiwan and Formosa as alternative titles. No decision has been made regarding the designation Penghu as either substitute or alternative for Pescadores (See TAB A).

In order to effect a change in existing rulings, the Department may submit a recommendation to the Board of Geographic Names that Penghu be adopted as an alternative name to Pescadores, and Taiwan and Penghu be given preference in official listings. A letter signed by the Department's Deputy Member on the Board is appropriate for that purpose (TAB B).

While it may be possible to establish that Taiwan and Penghu be adopted as exclusive rather than preferred alternatives, there is likelihood that objections would be raised by other Departments, some of which are required by law to follow conventional English usage.

Even in cases such as Iran-Persia, where the change has been requested by the foreign government itself, the Department, in order to effect the change in government-wide nomenclature, has submitted a recommendation to the Board on Geographic Names (TAB C).

Recommendation

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Recommendation

That, if a change be desired, a request to the Board of Geographic Names be authorized (TAB B).

Concurrences

FE/CA - Edwin W. Martin
P - Jesse M. MacKnight
L - Conrad E. Snow

Attachments

TAB A - Taiwan (Formosa) policy ... A survey.
TAB B - Letter to Board on Geographic Names.
TAB C - Memorandum dtd 3/3/55 from CE to OLI subject Change of name, Persia to Iran.

W. Park Armstrong, Jr.

OLI:ASBuford,III:HLee:mb 3-4-55

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